

Day 5 — Mapping Customer Journeys to Product Features

Activity packet for participant triads. Today's job: convert the week's strategy work into a **customer journey map** with three prioritized feature concepts that feed directly into Monday's Week-3 PRD drafting.

Where we are in the week

Days 1–4 produced: a Tier Sheet, a defensible North Star, three design principles, and an AI-assembled Strategy Brief. Today the triads bring those artifacts together by **mapping the actual user journey** through their problem and proposing the features that would most reduce friction.

Friday afternoon is the **Week-2 readout** — each triad presents an integrated strategy package that previews their Week-3 mini-capstone PRD.

Inputs

- The triad's **NS Defense Card** (Day 2)
- The triad's **3 design principles** (Day 3)
- The triad's **Strategy Brief** (Day 4) — especially the 5 pain themes
- The triad's **Tier Sheet** (Day 1, refreshed Day 2)
- The **Journey Map Canvas** (handout, A2 size)

What a customer journey map *is* and *is not*

IS	IS NOT
A timeline of user actions, thoughts, and emotions through a defined experience	A flowchart of your product's screens
Grounded in observed and reported behavior (Week 1 + Day 4)	An idealized version of how you wish people used your product
Specific to one persona doing one job	A "general user" map
A tool to find friction, then a tool to find leverage	An end-state that lives in a wiki and never updates

The TPM job is not to draw the prettiest map. It is to **find where the friction is highest** and connect those points to features that move the metrics.

The Journey Map Canvas (today's main artifact)

A single A2 sheet with five horizontal swim lanes:

SWIM LANE	CONTENTS
1. Stage	Phases of the journey (e.g., Pre-shift → On-shift → Mid-shift change → After-shift)
2. Actions	What the user is <i>doing</i> (concrete verbs)
3. Thoughts	What they're thinking ("Did I close that ticket?")
4. Emotions	Curve from frustration to satisfaction (4-point scale)
5. Touchpoints / friction	Where product, paper, phone calls, and other systems intersect; star the friction

Below the swim lanes, two columns:

- **Top 5 friction points** (ranked by Week-1 pain severity)
- **Top 3 feature concepts** (each linked to a friction point and a metric it would move)

Activity 1 — Anchor the Journey

Format: Triad • 35 min • Block 1

Purpose

Draw the **factual** journey before debating fixes. Most triads jump to features prematurely — today's discipline is to map first.

Setup

Each triad has its Day-3 persona, Day-4 Strategy Brief, and the Journey Map Canvas (A2 paper or large whiteboard). Stickies for stages.

Steps

Triad protocol

1. **Pick one persona** (5 min). Almost certainly the dispatcher persona from Week 1 Day 3. Confirm.
2. **Pick one journey scope** (10 min). The triad chooses one of:
 - Pre-shift through end-of-shift (a single workday)
 - First-30-days experience (onboarding-heavy)
 - Mid-shift exception (a tech calls out sick — the canonical disruption)
3. **Stage the journey** (15 min). Sticky notes on the Canvas. 5–8 stages.
4. **Sanity-check against evidence** (5 min). Does each stage map to something in Week 1's interviews/tickets? If not, mark as inferred.

Deliverable

A staged journey skeleton — actions and stages only. Thoughts/emotions/friction come next.

Activity 2 — Fill the Lanes

Format: Triad • 40 min • Block 2

Purpose

Populate Thoughts, Emotions, and Touchpoints lanes — and surface friction.

Setup

Each triad has its staged journey from Activity 1 and the Week-1 interview transcripts within reach.

Steps

Triad protocol

1. **Thoughts lane** (10 min). For each stage, write 1–2 quotes (real or composite) that capture what the user is thinking. Use language from the Week-1 interview transcripts where possible.
2. **Emotions lane** (10 min). Score each stage on a 4-point curve: 😊 → 😐 → 😞 → 😡. Plot.
3. **Touchpoints lane** (15 min). For each stage, list every system or person the user interacts with: your product, paper, phone, other software, manager, customer. **Star the friction.**
4. **Walk-through review** (5 min). One triad member narrates the whole journey to the other two. Capture surprises.

What "good" looks like

- The emotions curve is **not flat**. A flat curve usually means the triad is sanitizing.
- Friction stars cluster at 2–3 stages, not 8. If everything is friction, nothing is.
- Touchpoints include **non-product** systems (paper, phone). Most journey maps under-represent these and miss the integration story.

Bridge to Week 4

The non-product touchpoints are the input to **Week 4's "system components" mapping**. Don't lose them.

Deliverable

A populated Journey Map Canvas with stages, actions, thoughts (quotes), emotions curve, touchpoints (including non-product), and friction stars clustered at 2–3 stages.

Activity 3 — From Friction to Features

Format: Triad • 40 min • Block 3

Purpose

Translate the highest-friction stages into **3 feature concepts** that pass the strategy test.

Setup

Each triad has its populated Journey Map (with friction stars), Tier Sheet, and 3 design principles visible.

Steps

The strategy test for a feature concept

A feature concept earns a place on your map if it passes all three:

- ☐ **Friction link:** Names the specific stage and friction it would reduce
- ☐ **Metric link:** Names the operational signal or KPI it would move
- ☐ **Principle link:** Aligns with at least one of the triad's 3 design principles (or names which it deliberately trades off)

Triad protocol

1. **Brainstorm 8 candidate features** (15 min). Volume first. No vetting.
2. **Apply the strategy test** (15 min). Three checkboxes per candidate. Most will fail one.
3. **Cull to 3** (10 min). The 3 that pass cleanest.

The feature card template

```
## Feature concept: <short name>

**Stage(s) addressed:** <journey stages>
**Friction reduced:** <specific friction starred on the map>
**Metric it moves:** <op-signal or KPI from your Tier Sheet>
**Aligned principle:** <which of the 3 from Day 3>
**Trade-off / risk:** <what we'd give up; what could go wrong>
**Validation:** how would we know it actually moved the metric in 30 days?
```

Deliverable

3 feature cards per triad, each linking a journey stage + friction + metric + principle + trade-off + validation approach.

Activity 4 — Friday Readouts (Full Week-2 Package)

Format: Triad • 45 min total + readouts • Block 4

Purpose

Each triad delivers a **12-minute integrated strategy package** to the cohort. Peer + instructor scoring.

Setup

Each triad has all six Week-2 artifacts: NS Defense Card, Tier Sheet, 3 design principles, Strategy Brief, Journey Map, 3 feature cards.

Steps

What to present (in order)

1. **North Star + counter-metric** (1 min)
2. **Tier Sheet causal chain** (2 min) — three sentences
3. **One design principle in detail** (2 min) — the one they expect most pushback on
4. **Journey map walk-through** (4 min) — narrate the persona's journey, friction stars

5. **3 feature concepts** (3 min) — each with stage, friction, metric, principle

Scoring rubric (live, by peers + instructor)

DIMENSION	WEIGHT	WHAT "EXEMPLARY" LOOKS LIKE
Metric coherence	25%	NS, KPIs, op-signals form a believable causal chain
North Star defense	20%	Triad can name + rebut three pitfalls applied to their own NS
Journey realism	20%	Map references observed Week-1 pain points; non-product touchpoints present
Feature linkage	15%	Each top feature ties to journey friction AND a Tier Sheet metric
AI-use transparency	10%	Where AI summarized research, prompts and validation steps disclosed
Design awareness	10%	At least one UX principle named with trade-off acknowledged

Triad workflow before readouts

1. **Assemble the package** (15 min). One artifact set, ordered.
2. **Rehearse** (15 min). Time each section. Cut anything that doesn't serve.
3. **Decide who speaks** (5 min). All three voices on the readout, not one designated talker.
4. **Predict the toughest peer challenge** (10 min). Be ready for it.

Readouts (timing)

- 12 min per triad
- 3 min Q&A per triad
- All scores tallied

Deliverable

A 12-minute integrated readout per triad covering NS → Tier Sheet → one design principle → journey map → 3 feature concepts, with all three voices presenting.

End-of-week checkpoint

Each triad leaves the week with:

- ✓ **Locked North Star** with counter-metric and three pitfall rebuttals
- ✓ **Refreshed Metrics Tier Sheet** with NS / KPIs / 6+ operational signals
- ✓ **Three design principles** with one decision each principle would force
- ✓ **AI-Assembled Strategy Brief** with provenance log
- ✓ **Customer journey map** for one persona, one scope
- ✓ **Three feature concepts** that pass friction + metric + principle test

Every artifact is an input to **Week 3's PRD drafting**. Triads should leave the room with all six in shareable form.